

1 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Plan a small shared event

What we are practising

Allocate time, include a buffer and explain a scheduling choice.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Draw time blocks rather than a written timetable.

Before you begin

An imaginary event runs 4:00-4:45 and needs 5 minutes welcome, 25 activity and 10 cleanup.

The event is fictional; actual gatherings and responsibilities remain adult decisions.

Try it together

1. Add the required durations and find the time left over.
2. Place the tasks in a sensible order and include the spare time as a buffer.
3. Write start and end times for every block.
4. Imagine the activity starts three minutes late and adjust without finishing after 4:45.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Why might a plan with every minute already occupied be harder to follow?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Compare choices with criteria

What we are practising

Compare options consistently and explain a reasoned decision.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Discuss a simple two-column list aloud.

Before you begin

Compare a drawing session, story circle and construction challenge for an imaginary group.

Do not assume anyone's needs; in real groups ask participants or the responsible adult.

Try it together

1. Choose three criteria, such as setup time, materials and ways everyone can participate.
2. For each activity, write one advantage and one limitation using the same criteria.
3. Agree which criterion matters most in this scenario.
4. Make a choice and explain what new information could change it.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Would a different group's needs lead to a different good choice?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Repair a crossed message

What we are practising

Separate the words received from assumptions about the sender's intention.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Role-play the exchange aloud without a device.

Before you begin

Use a fictional message: Fine. Do it yourself.

Use fictional messages only; children should ask a trusted adult for help with threatening or upsetting real messages.

Try it together

1. List two possible interpretations without deciding which is true.
2. Write a neutral clarification, such as Do you mean I should finish alone, or shall we discuss it later?
3. Have a partner choose an intended meaning and answer.
4. Rewrite the original message so that meaning is clearer.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What information is missing when we see only a short written message?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 30 minutes

Teach a skill in five steps

What we are practising

Break a familiar skill into ordered steps with a clear check for success.

What you need

Paper / Pencil / Materials for a safe paper-folding task

Teach drawing a simple shape pattern instead of folding.

Before you begin

Choose a safe skill you know, such as folding a standing paper name card.

Choose safe paper tasks only; do not teach tool use, cooking or physical skills without suitable adult supervision.

Try it together

1. Perform the task slowly and identify up to five main steps.
2. Write each step with an action verb and add a sketch if useful.
3. Ask a partner to follow the guide while you observe without immediately correcting.
4. Revise the point where they paused, then include a final success check.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What did you know automatically that a beginner needed you to explain?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 20 minutes

Share less, explain why

What we are practising

Match shared information to an audience and purpose.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Use a spoken imaginary invitation and list edits aloud.

Before you begin

Imagine a private family drawing session announced on a public noticeboard with a child's full name, home address and daily routine.

Do not write real personal data, contact strangers or publish the practice invitation; adults decide actual sharing.

Try it together

1. Identify who needs the invitation and who can see the noticeboard.
2. Mark which details are unnecessary for the public audience.
3. Rewrite the notice without names, addresses or routines, directing interested adults to a responsible adult privately.
4. Explain why a private family plan may be better shared directly with invited adults.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Does useful information for one invited person belong on a public board?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

What did the team actually decide?

What we are practising

Distinguish a proposed idea from an agreed next step in team notes.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Write separate notes for a proposed idea and a confirmed next step.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A team says, “We liked the garden theme, but will choose after seeing two sketches.” How should its notes distinguish an idea from a decision?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Leave room for an estimate to change

What we are practising

Account for uncertainty when planning time and task scope.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Revise a fictional schedule to allow for an uncertain estimate.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional team has 30 minutes. It estimates 10 minutes to plan, 10 to draw and 10 to check a poster. What weakness in this plan could it address before starting?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Which jobs can we do together?

What we are practising

Separate independent tasks from tasks that depend on an earlier decision.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draw a task map showing what can happen together and what must wait.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A team must choose a story title, then letter that title on a cover. It must also draw a background that does not depend on the title. Which jobs could overlap, and which must wait?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Fair does not always mean identical

What we are practising

Explain a resource allocation using agreed needs rather than identical shares.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Explain a resource allocation using the fictional groups' stated needs.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two pretend groups share eight sheets. One needs six for an agreed booklet; the other needs two for signs. What allocation meets both stated needs, and what should they confirm first?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Separate an observation from a guess

What we are practising

Separate an observed fact from an assumed motive before asking for clarification.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Sort a fictional claim into observation, assumption and clarifying question.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional teammate has not added a drawing to the shared page. Someone says, "They do not care."
What is known, what is guessed, and what could be asked?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Four cards become eight

What we are practising

Negotiate changes to quantity, detail or time when a request grows.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Respond to a changed fictional request by naming its trade-offs.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A group has agreed to make four illustrated cards today. Someone requests eight instead, with the same time available. What must be discussed before agreeing?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Choose with evidence and a purpose

What we are practising

Use a small trial to support a provisional choice without overstating its evidence.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Make a provisional group choice and state one limit of its evidence.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend display needs signs readable from the back of a room. In a small trial, four of five volunteers read sign A and two of five read sign B from that spot. What could the team tentatively choose, and what should it avoid claiming?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

A trial before a permanent choice

What we are practising

Design an agreed comparison that respects differing preferences.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Plan a short comparison that respects two preferences.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two fictional club members disagree about starting meetings with drawing or storytelling. How could a short agreed trial help them choose without pretending either preference is wrong?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Pass the right version along

What we are practising

Include version information and an understanding check in a task handover.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Write a note that identifies the right draft and checks the next person understands.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One fictional editor finishes correcting a story and passes it to a cover designer. What should the handover include so the designer can begin with the right version?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Make responsibility visible

What we are practising

Specify a task's agreed owner, result and timing.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Rewrite a vague fictional task only after describing how agreement is reached.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional team note says, "Someone should bring the poster draft next time." What is missing, and how can the team improve the note without assigning a person who has not agreed?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Compare choices with agreed criteria

What we are practising

Compare options against the purpose and constraints of a particular occasion.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Compare two fictional options against space and time criteria.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend group chooses a game for a small table. Game A fits the table but takes 20 minutes; B fits and takes 10. The group has 12 minutes and wants everyone to finish. How can criteria guide its choice?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Ask before using someone's idea

What we are practising

Ask for permission before moving a privately shared idea into a public display.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Draft a permission request for a fictional creative contribution.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional writer shares an unfinished character idea privately with a teammate. The teammate wants it in the group's public story display. What conversation should happen first?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

A useful review after the project

What we are practising

Turn a broad team reflection into a specific change that can be tried and reviewed.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Turn a vague fictional reflection into one testable team habit.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

After a fictional group finishes a comic, someone says, “Next time we should communicate better.” How could the group turn this into one specific experiment for its next project?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

Make room for a different kind of contribution

What we are practising

Offer meaningful contribution choices without deciding another person's role for them.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Propose two useful fictional roles and an invitation to choose.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional team plans a spoken story performance. One member wants to contribute but does not want to speak before the group. How could the team offer a meaningful role without deciding for them?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 9-12 | 15 minutes

When colour printing is unavailable

What we are practising

Preserve essential information when an unavailable resource changes the plan.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

Keep examples fictional and participation voluntary; an adult can help read or act a role.

Try it together

1. Adapt fictional game instructions when one planned resource is unavailable.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A fictional group plans to teach a new game with a colour-coded sheet, but can print only in black and white. How can it preserve the purpose without relying on colour?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Plan a small shared event

A little hint

Required tasks total 40 minutes, leaving 5 minutes free.

Answer / what to notice

One plan: welcome 4:00-4:05, activity 4:05-4:30, buffer 4:30-4:35, cleanup 4:35-4:45.

The five-minute buffer can absorb a three-minute delay while preserving all required durations and the finish time.

Make it easier

Place three prepared time blocks on a timeline.

Take it further

Add a second activity and decide what to shorten, explaining the tradeoff.

Another day, away from the screen

Estimate and then observe the duration of one familiar household task.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Compare choices with criteria

A little hint

Distinguish a known requirement from a guessed preference.

Answer / what to notice

Any option can be reasonable if it fits the stated priorities; there is no universal winner.

Criteria make comparisons explicit, while different priorities can legitimately change the result.

Make it easier

Compare only two activities against one clear need.

Take it further

Weight one criterion twice as heavily and examine whether the decision changes.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the same comparison method for two ways to organize a pretend bookshelf.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Repair a crossed message

A little hint

Tone, timing and context may be missing; do not label one guess as a fact.

Answer / what to notice

A useful response asks about the task or intention without insulting or claiming to know the person's feelings.

Clarification can check meaning before a mistaken assumption shapes the next reply.

Make it easier

Choose between two prepared clarification questions.

Take it further

Write versions for a friend and a formal group task while keeping both respectful.

Another day, away from the screen

Collect three neutral phrases for checking meaning, such as Could you explain which part?

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Teach a skill in five steps

A little hint

For a fold, specify which edges meet and whether the paper starts flat.

Answer / what to notice

A strong guide lets the learner complete the task and recognize the result; revisions should address observed confusion.

Teaching exposes hidden steps and assumptions in a familiar process.

Make it easier

Give three picture steps with an adult's help.

Take it further

Create a version for someone using only one hand, then ask whether the adaptation is workable.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap guides and give one specific helpful suggestion each.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Share less, explain why

A little hint

Think about the smallest audience that actually needs each detail.

Answer / what to notice

A reasonable revision removes personal details and uses an adult-managed private invitation; publishing nothing publicly is also valid.

Audience and purpose determine what needs sharing; extra personal details can travel beyond the intended recipients.

Make it easier

Sort fictional details into needed for the invitation and not needed.

Take it further

Compare what belongs in a public announcement, a private invitation and no message at all.

Another day, away from the screen

Create a three-question check: who needs this, why, and can I share less?

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. What did the team actually decide?

A little hint

Ask which action everyone has already agreed to take.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Record the garden theme as a possibility, and record comparing two sketches as the agreed next step. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Clear records preserve uncertainty instead of turning a preference into an agreement.

Make it easier

Mark one statement “possible” and one “agreed.”

Take it further

Add who will prepare the sketches and when the choice will be revisited.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. Leave room for an estimate to change

A little hint

What happens if drawing takes three minutes longer than estimated?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Every minute is allocated, so a delay leaves no spare time. The team could simplify the drawing to leave a small buffer. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Estimates are uncertain; a plan can make that uncertainty visible and adjust scope.

Make it easier

Identify the total time and whether any is unassigned.

Take it further

Keep the checking step and explain which detail you would reduce first.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Which jobs can we do together?

A little hint

Draw an arrow only where one task needs another task's result.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Choosing the title and drawing the background can overlap; lettering the final title waits until the choice is made. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Some tasks can proceed independently, while others need a completed decision or result.

Make it easier

Compare only choosing the title and lettering it.

Take it further

Add a final check that needs both the background and title finished.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. Fair does not always mean identical

A little hint

Compare the requested amounts with the total before judging by appearance.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Allocate six and two after confirming the needs and that neither group has been overlooked; equal halves would not meet the booklet plan. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Fairness can use agreed needs as a criterion; it does not always require identical quantities.

Make it easier

Draw six boxes and two boxes to show the requests.

Take it further

If only seven sheets remain, propose a discussion about reducing or reusing one sheet.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. Separate an observation from a guess

A little hint

Could more than one explanation fit the missing drawing?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: The page has no drawing from them yet; their reason is unknown. Ask whether they understood the task or need a different role. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Separating visible facts from inferred motives leaves room to clarify the situation.

Make it easier

Choose which of the two statements can be checked on the page.

Take it further

Write two different possible explanations without declaring either true.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. Four cards become eight

A little hint

Which of quantity, detail or available time is flexible?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Discuss whether to simplify each card, extend the time or keep four; the group needs to agree which condition can change. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Increasing the amount of work can affect time and detail; naming the trade-off supports a realistic agreement.

Make it easier

Compare four detailed cards with eight simple cards.

Take it further

Write a revised agreement with a clear completion condition.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Choose with evidence and a purpose

A little hint

Connect the result to the stated viewing distance and group.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Choose A provisionally for that purpose, but do not claim five volunteers prove it is best for every reader or setting. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Evidence supports a decision within the conditions tested; a small trial has limited reach.

Make it easier

Compare which sign more volunteers read in this trial.

Take it further

Suggest a second trial that would answer one remaining question.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. A trial before a permanent choice

A little hint

Decide how the trial will be judged before seeing its result.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Try each opening once, agree beforehand what to notice, then discuss participation and the members' preferences. Other reasoned ideas can work.

An agreed comparison can reveal practical effects while leaving room for different tastes.

Make it easier

Choose one thing to notice, such as whether everyone gets a turn.

Take it further

Plan what to do if the two trials are equally useful.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. Pass the right version along

A little hint

What could go wrong if two files or titles have similar names?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Identify the final title and version, note any unresolved question, and ask the designer to repeat the next task in their own words. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A handover transfers the current information and checks that the next person understands it.

Make it easier

State only the final title and next action.

Take it further

Add a plan for who answers an unresolved question.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Make responsibility visible

A little hint

Replace “someone” and “next time” with agreed details.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Ask for a volunteer or an agreed assignment, then record that person’s name, the draft needed and the specific meeting. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A clear task needs an agreed owner, a concrete result and a known time.

Make it easier

Choose which missing detail tells the team who will act.

Take it further

Add how the person can report early if the task needs to change.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Compare choices with agreed criteria

A little hint

Check both constraints, not just the one you notice first.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: B meets both the space and stated time needs, so it fits this occasion; that does not make A a worse game in general. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Agreed criteria connect a choice to its purpose instead of treating preference as a universal ranking.

Make it easier

Circle the game whose estimated duration fits 12 minutes.

Take it further

Change the available time to 25 minutes and explain what remains undecided.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. Ask before using someone's idea

A little hint

Separate having heard the idea from having permission to display it.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Ask whether the writer wants the idea shared, in what form and with what credit; accept a refusal or a request to wait. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Receiving an idea privately does not establish permission to publish it in a different setting.

Make it easier

Ask whether the idea may be shown to the group at all.

Take it further

Write a response that preserves the writer's choice if they decline.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. A useful review after the project

A little hint

Name a behaviour, a time to try it and a way to notice its effect.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Agree to a short midpoint check where each person names what is finished and one question, then review whether it helped. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A specific, observable change is easier to try and evaluate than a broad wish.

Make it easier

Replace “communicate better” with one clear question to ask.

Take it further

Choose a second possible explanation if the next project goes better.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. Make room for a different kind of contribution

A little hint

The role should support the project and be chosen with the person.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Offer choices such as arranging scene cards or designing the opening image, then ask which role they would like or whether they have another idea. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Participation can take different forms; offering choices keeps the contributor involved in the decision.

Make it easier

Compare one speaking role and one drawing role.

Take it further

Explain how the group will acknowledge both visible and behind-the-scenes work.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. When colour printing is unavailable

A little hint

Ask what the colours were telling the players.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: Use distinct shapes or written labels for each group and check that the instructions refer to those same markers. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A fallback preserves the information people need while changing how it is represented.

Make it easier

Replace two colours with a circle and a triangle.

Take it further

Ask a partner to identify a remaining instruction that depends only on colour.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.